

Budget Justification — Annotated Sample

Illustrative federal proposal budget justification
Morgan State University | 3-year project | rates shown are illustrative

Illustrative sample authored by ORA Navigator for reference only — not a real submitted proposal. Adapt freely; verify all rules against the live solicitation and Morgan State ORA (443-885-4044).

A. Senior Personnel

Dr. A. Researcher, Principal Investigator (1.0 summer month/yr). The PI conceived the project and is responsible for overall scientific direction, supervision of personnel, and reporting. One summer month is requested in each of the three years, charged at the PI's institutional base salary with annual escalation of 3%. Effort is committed and will be tracked through Morgan State's effort-certification system.

Dr. C. Collaborator, Co-Investigator (0.5 summer month/yr). The co-I leads the domain-specific analyses described in Aim 2 and contributes to manuscript preparation.

B. Other Personnel

Graduate Research Assistant (1 GRA, 12 months/yr at 50% effort). The GRA conducts data collection, runs the analysis pipeline, and assists with dissemination. The stipend follows the institution's standard GRA rate; effort is 50% during the academic year consistent with graduate-assistantship policy.

Undergraduate Research Assistants (2, academic year). Two undergraduates support data preparation and literature review, advancing the project's broader-impacts training goals.

C. Fringe Benefits

Fringe benefits are applied to all salaries and wages at Morgan State's federally negotiated rates (faculty and staff at the negotiated full-time rate; student rates as applicable). Fringe is computed on committed salary, not on the total budget, and follows the rates in effect during each budget period.

D. Travel

Domestic conference travel (\$2,500/yr). Supports one trip per year for the PI or GRA to present results at a national meeting (airfare, lodging, registration, and per diem at institutional rates). **Project travel (\$1,000/yr)** supports local travel to the field site for data collection.

E. Participant Support Costs

Stipends and incentives (\$6,000/yr). Supports participant incentives for the study activities described in the project plan. Per sponsor policy, participant-support costs are budgeted as a separate category and are **excluded from the modified total direct cost (MTDC) base**, so no indirect costs are charged on them.

F. Materials, Supplies, and Other Direct Costs

Computing and software (\$3,000/yr) covers cloud compute for the analysis pipeline and required software licenses. **Publication costs (\$1,500 in Years 2–3)** cover open-access article fees. **Materials and supplies (\$1,200/yr)** cover consumables directly used by the project.

G. Indirect Costs (Facilities & Administrative)

Indirect costs are charged at Morgan State University's federally negotiated F&A rate, applied to the **modified total direct cost (MTDC)** base. MTDC excludes equipment, participant-support costs, and the portion of each subaward above \$25,000, consistent with 2 CFR 200. The applicable rate and rate-agreement date are listed in the budget form; no indirect costs are requested on the excluded categories above.

Total. The total requested budget is the sum of direct and indirect costs across the three budget periods; all figures reconcile to the line items on the sponsor budget form.